

Marketing Mix Strategies, Marketing Mix and Customer Behaviour

Marketing Mix

The Marketing Mix is a combination of marketing elements used by companies to promote and sell products or services successfully.

The main elements of the marketing mix are called the 4Ps:

1. Product
2. Price
3. Place
4. Promotion

The marketing mix helps businesses:

- Create better products
- Set suitable prices
- Promote products effectively
- Deliver products to customers easily



4Ps of Marketing Mix

Customer behaviour analysis helps companies understand:

- What customers buy
- Why they buy
- How they buy

Marketing Mix (4Ps)

1. Product - A product is a good or service offered to satisfy customer needs.

Features of Product

- Quality
- Design
- Brand name
- Packaging
- Warranty

Example:

- Apple focuses on product quality and design.
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2. Price - Price is the amount of money customers pay for a product or service.

Pricing Strategies

- Low pricing
 - Premium pricing
 - Discount pricing
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3. Place - Place refers to the distribution channels used to deliver products to customers.

Examples

- Retail stores
- Online websites
- Supermarkets

Example:

- Amazon uses online distribution for fast delivery.
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4. Promotion - Promotion means communicating product information to customers.

Methods of Promotion

- Advertising
- Sales promotion
- Social media marketing
- Personal selling

Marketing Mix Strategies

Marketing Mix Strategies are plans and techniques used by businesses to combine the 4Ps effectively to attract customers and increase sales.

1. Product Strategy

Companies improve product quality, design, and features to attract customers.

Example: Mobile companies launching new features regularly.

2. Pricing Strategy

Businesses choose pricing methods based on market demand and competition.

Example: Discount offers during festival seasons.

3. Distribution Strategy

Products are delivered through effective channels.

Example: Online food delivery services.

4. Promotion Strategy

Companies use advertisements and campaigns to increase sales.

Example: TV advertisements and social media promotions.

Importance of Marketing Mix Strategies

1. Helps increase sales
2. Improves customer satisfaction
3. Creates brand awareness
4. Supports business growth
5. Helps face market competition

Applications of Marketing Mix Strategies

- Retail business
- E-commerce companies
- Banking sector
- Food industries
- Healthcare services

Example:

- Coca-Cola uses strong promotion strategies to attract customers worldwide.
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Customer Behaviour

Customer Behaviour refers to the actions, decisions, how customers select, purchase, use, and respond to products and services.

Factors Affecting Customer Behaviour

1. Personal Factors

- Age
 - Income
 - Occupation
 - Lifestyle
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2. Psychological Factors

- Motivation
 - Perception
 - Attitude
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3. Social Factors

- Family
 - Friends
 - Social status
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4. Cultural Factors

Culture and traditions influence buying behavior.

Types of Customer Buying Behaviour

1. Complex Buying Behaviour

Customers spend more time before buying expensive products.

Example: Buying a car or laptop.

2. Habitual Buying Behaviour

Customers buy products regularly without much thinking.

Example: Soap or toothpaste.

3. Impulsive Buying Behaviour

Customers buy products suddenly without planning.

Example: Snacks near billing counters.

Importance of Customer Behaviour

1. Helps understand customer needs
2. Improves marketing strategies
3. Increases customer satisfaction
4. Helps in product development
5. Improves sales performance

Sales Planning and Selling Process

1. Sales Planning

Sales Planning is the process of setting sales goals, identifying sales strategies, and preparing activities to achieve business sales targets.

Sales is one of the most important functions in business organizations. Without proper sales planning and selling activities, companies cannot achieve business growth.

Sales planning helps organizations:

- Forecast sales
 - Allocate resources
 - Improve customer satisfaction
 - Increase revenue
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Objectives of Sales Planning

1. Increase sales revenue
2. Achieve business goals
3. Improve market share
4. Reduce sales risks
5. Improve customer satisfaction

Steps in Sales Planning

1. Setting Sales Objectives - The company defines sales goals and targets. **Example:** Increase product sales by 15% next year

2. Market Analysis

The business studies:

- Customer needs
- Market trends
- Competitors
- Demand conditions

3. Sales Forecasting - Predicting future sales using historical data and market analysis. **Example:** Forecasting festival season sales demand.

4. Identifying Target Customers - The company identifies customers who are most likely to buy the product.

5. Developing Sales Strategies - The organization prepares plans to achieve sales goals.

Strategies Include

- Pricing strategy
- Promotion strategy
- Distribution strategy
- Customer relationship strategy

6. Budget Preparation - Preparing the budget required for sales activities.

Includes

- Advertising cost
- Employee salary
- Promotional expenses

7. Implementation and Monitoring - Sales plans are put into action

Activities

- Product promotion
- Customer communication
- Sales campaigns

8. Monitoring and Evaluation -The company measures sales performance and compares it with targets.

Diagram of Sales Planning Process



Selling Process

The **Selling Process** is a series of steps followed by salespersons to identify customers, present products, and successfully complete sales.

The selling process helps businesses:

- Attract customers
- Build relationships
- Increase product sales

The selling process is a step-by-step procedure followed by salespersons to sell products successfully.

Steps in Selling Process

1. Prospecting - Finding potential customers who may buy the product.

Sources:

- Advertisements
- Social media
- Customer referrals

2. Pre-Approach - Collecting information about customers before contacting them.

3. Approach - The salesperson makes the first contact with the customer.

Example: Greeting customers politely and introducing products.

4. Presentation and Demonstration - The salesperson explains product features and benefits.

Example: Explaining smartphone features and functionalities.

5. Handling Objections - Answering customer doubts and questions.

Example: Explaining product warranty and price benefits.

6. Closing the Sale - Encouraging the customer to make the purchase decision.

Example: Offering discounts or special offers.

7. Follow-Up - Maintaining contact with customers after the sale.

- Builds customer loyalty
- Improves customer satisfaction

Advantages of Sales Planning and Selling Process

1. Improves customer relationships
2. Increases sales performance
3. Helps understand customer needs
4. Builds customer trust
5. Increased profits

Diagram of Selling Process



Applications of Sales Planning and Selling Process

- Retail business
- E-commerce companies
- Insurance companies

Example:

- Amazon uses sales analytics and customer targeting strategies to improve online sales.